

## Finishing your cartoon character - Adding hands, legs, and shoes on Adobe Animate

If you've reached this far, your cartoon character is 90% ready, and you have mastered the editing tools and skills that you need to turn primitive objects into discernible shapes and objects. Now, using the same skills learned above, you need to add the remaining features to your cartoon, namely hands, legs, and footwear (shoes).

The hands and legs should be fairly simple—you need a basic idea of alignment and sizes to draw primitive rectangular objects that have the same color as the skin tone of your cartoon character and proportionally sized regarding the body that you've drawn so far. Use the “Rectangle Primitive Object” tool to create the first hand, or simply duplicate the “neck” layer and add it on one side of the T-shirt, right below one “arm” of the t-shirt. Once this is done, move the “hand” layer behind the arm/skirt layers using the “Modify” menu, as we have learned above. Finally, use [Shift] + [Alt] to replicate this hand and create an exact copy, and align it on the opposite side.

For the legs, use the same process as the hands - only, you'll need to use longer rectangles. Always stick to the principle of creating one body part first (one eye, one leg, one arm, one hand, etc.) and then replicate it using [Shift] + [Alt] to create perfect symmetry in the body parts of your cartoon character.

Once you've added the hands and legs, you can give your character a beautiful pair of shoes by dropping and shaping oval objects that are tiny and use a contrasting color. In this example, we're going with blue-colored shoes, which will be created by cutting out “edges” from a blue set of oval shapes, and then grouping them together in the object editing mode to first create one shoe and then replicate/align it to the other leg to get a complete picture.

Once you have added the hands, legs, and shoes, you can further enhance this image by adding “highlights” to the hair of your cartoon character; to do this, cut out an irregular shape using the “Snap-to-object” feature and color it one shade lighter than the actual hair color. On digital screens, this gives an excellent natural look to your character. Lastly, you can add digital patterns on the clothing of your character too, to make the resulting image look like this: